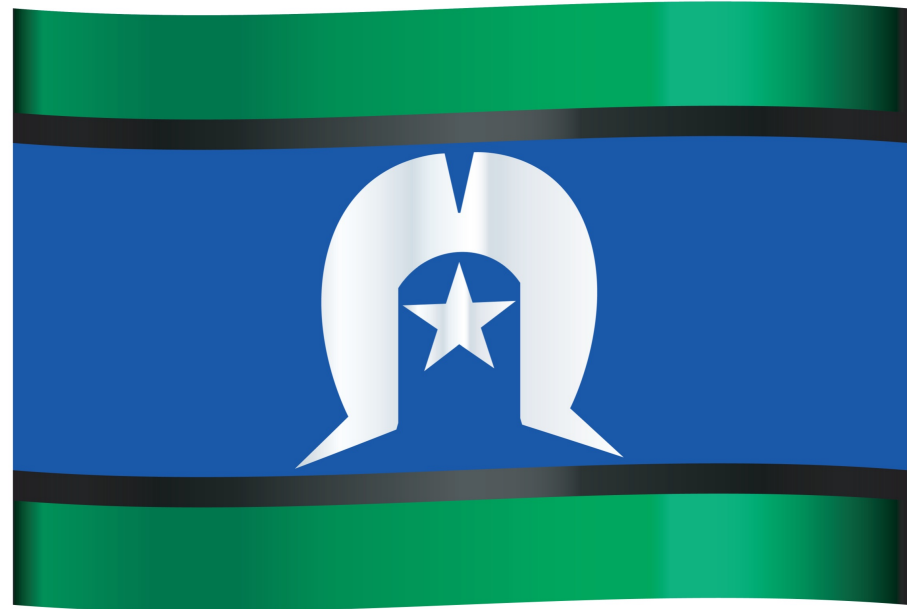


A photograph of two women standing outdoors in a garden-like setting. The woman on the left has dark hair in a ponytail, wears a white t-shirt and a patterned scarf, and is smiling while looking at an open book. The woman on the right has brown hair in a ponytail, wears a black cardigan over a floral top, and is also smiling while looking at the book. The book has a green cover with a white diamond pattern. The background is a blurred garden with green plants and a path. A semi-transparent dark blue circle is overlaid on the image, containing the text.

Parents and Carers Workshop

Primary · Supporting your Autistic child to flourish

Acknowledgement of Country



A close-up photograph of two hands, one from a lighter-skinned person and one from a darker-skinned person, both holding and pouring bright red soil. The soil is falling from the top hand into the bottom hand. The background is a blurred natural setting with green foliage and a clear blue sky. The text "Statement of reconciliation" is overlaid in white on the right side of the image.

Statement of reconciliation

First Nations people are advised that this workshop may contain images and voices of people who are no longer with us.



Everyone is welcome at this workshop. We want you to feel that it is ok to be authentically yourself.

Please let us know if there is anything we can do that helps to include you in the workshop.

Everyone is welcome to use their own strategies to help them engage and to participate effectively.



Housekeeping



Tea / Coffee



Exits



Facilities



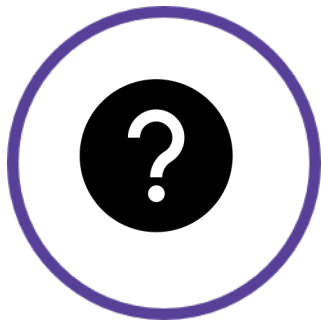
Phones



No Smoking / Vaping



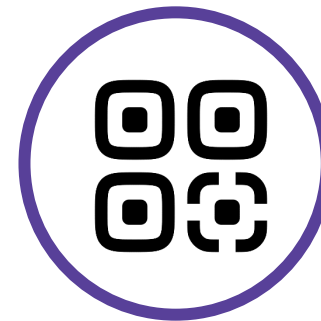
Personal Needs



Questions



Workbook



Other Information



Evaluation

Introductions

At your table, introduce yourselves briefly to each other.

Who you are

Your name, and who you are here for.

Your child or children

Their age or year level, if you would like to share it.

One thing

What would you like to know by the end of the day?

Workshop overview

9:30 - 10:15

Session 1 · Supporting your Autistic child to flourish

10:15 - 11:00

Session 2 · Understanding Autistic experience: sensory and thinking

11:00 - 11:15

Morning tea

11:15 - 12:15

Session 3 · Communication, connection and managing daily capacity

12:15 - 12:45

Lunch

12:45 - 1:30

Session 4 · Home and community

1:30 - 2:10

Session 5 · Partnership with the school

2:10 - 2:30

Session 6 · Full circle

Language and autism

Words matter, and people have different preferences.

Identity-first

Many Autistic people prefer "Autistic person". Autism is part of who they are.

Person-first

Some people prefer "person on the autism spectrum". That choice is theirs.

Follow their lead

Use the words your child and your family are comfortable with.

Today we use identity-first language, and we respect every preference.

Discussion activity

What are some things you love or value about your child?

- 1 Think of three things that make them who they are: strengths, joys, interests, connections.
- 2 Write them in your workbook. Not needs or challenges, just who they are.
- 3 Share one with the people at your table, if you would like to.

Parent and carer experience

You know your child

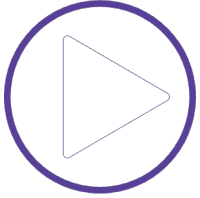
Today builds on what you already know about your child with shared language, useful ideas and practical tools.

Your experience matters

Your knowledge and experiences are welcome here.

A partnership

You are the expert on your child. We bring information about neurodiversity-affirming practice to talk through together.



Young people's voices

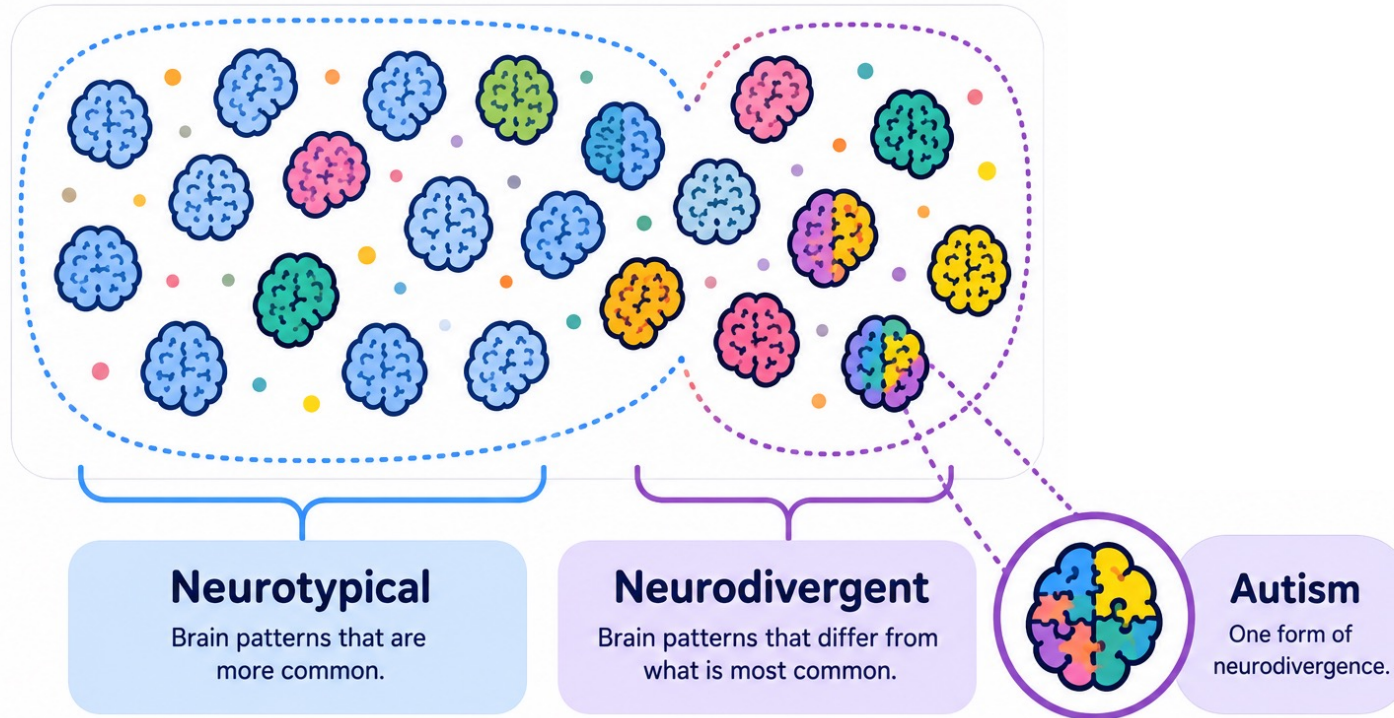


What did you notice?



- What stayed with you?
- What would you like to understand more deeply about your child?

Neurodiversity and neurodivergence



Neurodiversity is the whole picture.

Neurotypical and neurodivergent describe brain patterns within neurodiversity.

Autism is one expression of that diversity.

Neurodiversity affirming

**Differences
are not
deficits**

Acknowledging
different ways of
knowing, doing, being
and belonging

All people have
strengths and
experience challenges

There is no right or
wrong way to think,
learn or behave

Everyone experiences
and interacts with the
world differently

Intersectionality

People have many different parts to their identity. When these overlap, they can affect the opportunities, support, barriers and experiences a person has in life.

Gender

Sexuality

Race

Age

Religion

Ethnicity

Disability

Class

Education

Co-occurring
conditions

Autism as difference

Dynamic disability

Your child's capacity can change from minute to minute, day to day and term to term. Same child, different capacity.

Fluctuating capacity

Your rights at school

Disability Discrimination Act 1992

Makes it unlawful to treat someone unfairly because of disability, including in education.

Disability Standards for Education 2005

The school must consult your child, or you on their behalf, about reasonable adjustments, so your child can take part on the same basis as other children.

What you can ask

How will we be consulted?
What adjustments are in place? How and when will they be reviewed?

Plain-language guides for families are available from the Department of Education.

Joy and flourishing

Autistic experience is human experience

Joy, connection and belonging matter.

Every family is different

It can take time to understand and support needs.

Small moments count

Small moments and successes can matter as much as big ones.

Doing things differently

is fine when it helps your family flourish.

Today

We will explore ways to understand needs and find supports that fit.